★ ★ ★ GUIDED MEDITATION

Finger Labyrinth

A guided meditation for calm, centering and stress reduction

> *"Throughout the long history of labyrinths whenever and wherever society is going through rapid change and development the labyrinth has blossomed. Now, humanity is seeking the sure path of the labyrinth in an uncertain and confusing world."*
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> **— Jeff Saward, labyrinth historian**

Invocation

Let us begin with a moment of reflection, calling upon the spirit of learning within us.

Purpose

This practice uses a finger labyrinth and simple stress-management techniques to reduce stress, increase relaxation, ease frustration, and build mindfulness, calm, meditation and centering. A finger labyrinth can be traced with your hand on a printed labyrinth, a labyrinth you have walked, one you draw yourself, or a finger labyrinth app.

For a printed labyrinth, use our companion handout, Printable Labyrinths.

Recognition

As we move into the consciousness of knowing and seeing ourselves as perfect, we are not subject to our old patterns of thought and belief, but aware there is a divine pattern already existing within.

The purpose of a finger labyrinth is to center ourselves, meditate and pray.

As we center ourselves: place your finger at the opening of the labyrinth. Pray or meditate silently for 20 seconds. When you are ready, slowly move your finger (right or left forefinger) forward along the labyrinth path. Move at your own pace toward the center as you slowly breathe in, then slowly breathe out, again slowly breathing in, slowly breathing out. Quiet your mind as you move through the labyrinth and pay attention to thoughts or feelings that may surface. What needs to be changed, forgiven, cleared, confronted, or healed in your life?

Unification

We are one with God that is in all of us, right now, here and now.

As we slowly move toward the center, rest your finger there for a moment as you slowly breathe in, slowly breathe out, then slowly breathe in again, then slowly breathe out again.

Realization

As we declare right action taking place, we embrace meditation, breathing, and the spiritual truth of our being, knowing we are feeling more centered, more relaxed, and more peaceful in mind, body and spirit.

Now, as we prepare to leave the labyrinth, place your finger at the center and follow the same path out. Slowly breathe in, slowly breathe out while being mindful of your thoughts, and hold space for meditation or a prayer.

Thanksgiving

As we return to the beginning, we express our gratitude for the blessings that already exist in our lives and for the people we hold dear, as we slowly breathe in and slowly breathe out and gently lift our finger from the labyrinth's end, giving thanks and gratitude and releasing this into the universe as we say, and so it is!

Benediction

May the energy of curiosity guide us as we embark on this learning journey, and so it is!

Reference

Adapted from the book The Awkward Season: Prayers for Lent by Pamela C. Hawkins, pp. 111–112. Copyright © 2009 by Upper Room Books. Used with permission.

You may also be interested in: Walking the Labyrinth, a guided walk and videos at cherishconsulting.com/labyrinths